

## CORPORATE NEWS snippets



### Bharti and Dixon announce joint venture

Dixon and Bharti Enterprises are coming together to form a joint company that will manufacture telecom gear in India. The news came just months after the government of India announced a production linked incentive scheme for manufacturing telecom products in the country. The new company will aim to manufacture modems, routers, set-top boxes, and the IoT devices for telecom sector. The JV company, once formed, will be owned 26 percent by Bharti Enterprises and the rest by Dixon.

### Hero Electric to expand EV plant capacity

Hero Electric is preparing to invest seven billion rupees over the coming three to four years for the expansion of its plant capacity from 75,000 units to one million units of 2-wheeler electric vehicles (EVs). The first phase of the expansion will involve increasing the production capacity to 300,000 units. This move comes as the EV industry witnesses a surge in electric 2-wheelers' demand in the market, which is expected to rise even higher in the next few years.

### BEL reports turnover of 135 billion rupees

Bharat Electronics Limited (BEL) has achieved a turnover of about 135 billion rupees (provisional and unaudited) for year ending March 2021 against previous year's turnover of about 126 billion. BEL achieved export sales of around US\$50 million during the year. Major products exported include coastal surveillance system, trans-receive modules, Bharati radio, identification of friend or foe interrogator, electro-optic system, compact multi-purpose advanced stabilisation system, electro-mechanical parts, radar fingerprinting system, low band receivers, spares for radars, etc.

### Coal India might start fabricating solar wafers

Coal India is looking at the possibility of foraying into solar wafer manufacture in India. The information was revealed by Coal India's chairman Pramod Agarwal in an interaction with Reuters. Coal India plans to invest US\$1.73 billion solely targeted towards the solar industry in India. It is worth mentioning here that no company manufactures solar wafers in India currently.

### Optimus acquires full stake In JV unit with Wistron

The joint venture between Wistron and Optimus Infracom has ended after Optimus acquired the 19.91 percent shares held by Wistron in the subsidiary Optimus Electronics Ltd. With this acquisition, Optimus Infracom, which previously held 80.09 percent stake in the joint venture unit, will now wholly own it. The joint venture between Optimus Infracom and Wistron Corporation, a major supplier to Apple, was how the world's second-largest contract manufacturer had entered India.

### AIWA planning to re-launch products in India

AIWA is returning to India with five products in the true wireless stereo and audio segments, as per a report. The Japanese consumer electronics brand, which had registered

its Indian subsidiary in February 2021, will invest a total of US\$10 million in its first phase of operations.

### Syska wins EESL's tender for ten million LED bulbs

Syska LED has won a tender to supply ten million LED bulbs. Floated by the state-run Energy Efficiency Services Ltd's subsidiary Convergence Energy Services Ltd (CESL), this tender



*Representational image*

will require Syska to supply these LED bulbs in rural areas. The tender was floated under the recently launched Gram Ujala scheme. The Gram Ujala scheme, as per CESL, is a scheme that is offering LED bulbs at world's cheapest prices in rural areas at ten rupees.

### Airtel's Nettle acquires full stake in OneWeb

Airtel subsidiary Nettle Infrastructure Investments has acquired complete stake in OneWeb India Communications Pvt Ltd for an undisclosed amount. It was an all-cash transaction. OneWeb recently launched 36 satellites through Arianespace from the Vostochny cosmodrome in Russia. The company is open to entering the country either directly or through a commercial partnership. OneWeb is preparing to launch its fast broadband services in India by June 2022.

### Okinawa Autotech setting up components unit in Rajasthan

Okinawa Autotech is setting up a plant to manufacture motors and controls for its scooters at its upcoming 500,000 units per annum plant at Alwar in Rajasthan, which is scheduled for commissioning late in May or early June. Jeetender Sharma, founder and managing director of Okinawa, said that the company is investing 700 million rupees to set up the unit in Alwar. This will make Okinawa the first and the only EV 2-wheeler manufacturer to have own motor and control unit in the country.

### HMD Global planning to make India an export hub

Finnish mobile manufacturer HMD Global, best known for manufacturing and selling Nokia mobile phones, is eyeing to make India an export hub in the future and is in close collaboration with Indian electronics manufacturing services (EMS) companies for the same. The company is looking at opportunities to work in collaboration with Indian suppliers and the country's government to figure out how it can set up a manufacturing base in the country.